

LinkedIn Post - 31 May 2026

Schedule: Monday 9:00 AM | Topic: Research Paper Timelines | Tone: Professional

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How long does it REALLY take to publish at ICML/NeurIPS/ICLR?

I came across a Reddit thread where researchers shared their real timelines. No fluff, just data.

The numbers:

- Fastest individual paper (idea to preprint): 3 months
- Realistic average: 6-12 months
- Most common case: 1-2 years from start to acceptance
- The outlier: 3+ years (projects that stall and restart)

The typical timeline:

Idea + initial experiments 2-4 months
Solid results + writing 1-2 months
Internal revisions 2-4 weeks
Submission + rebuttal 2-3 months
Submit to camera-ready 6-9 months total

What nobody tells you:

- Pre-deadline crunch is brutal. People working 12h x 7 days.
- 80% of time goes into experiments that don't work.
- Rebuttal is a lottery - reviewers are random, contradictory.
- Many papers start as side projects, consume your life.

My take:

Publish because you have something worth sharing, not for prestige.

The process is long, frustrating, and ROI isn't always there.

But when it pays off? It's unmatched.

Anyone else in this space? Drop your experience below.

#MachineLearning #Research #NeurIPS #ICML #AI #DevLife

Generated by Ranukita - 31 May 2026